

REQUEST FOR INFORMATION

RFI-2026-014 — Airborne Multi-Spectral Sensor Pod

Issued: 14 July 2026 Responses due: 28 August 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

The Program Office is conducting market research to identify mature, modular airborne sensor pod solutions suitable for integration on Group 4 and Group 5 unmanned aerial systems. This RFI seeks information on current capabilities, technical maturity, production readiness, and applicable regulatory constraints. The information contained herein is provided for planning purposes only. Nothing in this document shall be construed as a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation or award a contract.

2. Background

Current fielded sensor pods rely on proprietary interfaces that constrain technology refresh and increase lifecycle cost. The Program Office intends to pursue an open-architecture approach for the next increment and requires insight into industry readiness to support that approach. Respondents are encouraged to describe relevant flight heritage and production experience.

3. Requested Information

Respondents shall address each of the following items. Responses should reference supporting evidence where available.

3.1 Open Architecture Compliance. The respondent shall state whether the proposed solution complies with Modular Open Systems Approach (MOSA) standards, and shall identify the specific open standards implemented (e.g., SOSA, OMS/UCI).

3.2 Unit Weight. The respondent shall state the total unit weight of the delivered pod, in kilograms, including mounting hardware.

3.3 Technology Readiness. The respondent shall state the current Technology Readiness Level (TRL 1-9) of the proposed solution and provide supporting evidence such as test or flight demonstration history.

3.4 Export Control. The respondent shall identify any ITAR or other export-control restrictions applicable to the proposed solution, including the relevant USML category where applicable.

3.5 Schedule. The respondent shall state the lead time, in months from contract award, to delivery of a first article.

3.6 Environmental. The respondent shall state the operating temperature range of the proposed solution in degrees Celsius.

3.7 Reliability. The respondent shall state the demonstrated or predicted mean time between failures (MTBF) of the proposed solution, in hours.

4. Submission Instructions

Responses shall not exceed 25 pages, prepared in 12-point font with one-inch margins, submitted in PDF format. Marketing brochures do not count against the page limit but will not be evaluated. Responses shall be submitted electronically no later than 1600 EDT on the date specified above. Questions regarding this RFI shall be submitted in writing no later than ten business days prior to the response date.

5. Points of Contact

Primary: Contracting Officer, AFLCMC/XYZ, rfi-2026-014@example.mil. Technical questions will be forwarded to the program technical lead. Telephone inquiries will not be accepted.

6. Disclaimers

The information contained herein is provided for planning purposes only. Nothing in this document shall be construed as a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation or award a contract. The information contained herein is provided for planning purposes only. Nothing in this document shall be construed as a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation or award a contract. The information contained herein is provided for planning purposes only. Nothing in this document shall be construed as a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation or award a contract.